



almost as big as the whole of Europe, it has less than 3 percent of the population Europe has. About 80 percent of people live in cities along the coast—mostly the east and southeast coasts—and most of the

area in the center of the country is desert. Australia is proud to be a multicultural nation. The first inhabitants, the Aborigines, now make up 1.5 percent of the population.

The outback

The area between the coasts and the desert of Australia is known as the outback. It is one of the hottest, driest areas in the world and is a very difficult to raise crops. Livestock, however, such as sheep and cattle, can survive and are kept on huge farms there.

If someone on an outback farm becomes sick or injured, the flying doctor arrives by plane.

FARMING BIG STYLE

Less than 5 percent of the population are farmers, yet over half of the land is used for grazing. A single sheep or cattle station is sometimes so big that it can take three or four days to travel across it.

1 Finding the herd

Because of the huge areas that the cattle and sheep are free to roam, farmers frequently use motorcycles or quadbikes to monitor their animals.

2 Rounding up

Beef cattle graze on dry grass and drink water drawn from wells. When they need to be herded back to the station, helicopters are used.

3 Closing in

Helicopters communicate with farmers in ground vehicles and between them help to drive the cattle into large enclosures.

